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 PURPOSE : The standard every IEBC Academy teacher follows, whatever class they teach.
 Read this first. Each class has its own lesson-plan guide (T01-T17) that assumes you know this playbook.
 AUDIENCE : IEBC Academy teachers, co-instructors and assignment reviewers (internal).
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IEBC Academy Teaching Playbook

Why this exists: IEBC classes will be taught by different people. A student who takes "AI Admin Automation" from one teacher in March and a friend who takes it from another teacher in June should get the same outcomes, the same deliverable and the same quality. This playbook is how we make that happen while still letting each teacher be themselves.

1. The one rule

Every class ends with something working in the student's business.

Not "they understood it." Not "they saw a demo." A working automation, a live website, a filled-in template, a drafted grant section. If a session ends and a student has nothing they built, the session failed, no matter how good the lecture was.

2. The IEBC Build-Along Method

Every lesson, live or recorded, follows the same four-step arc. Teachers can change examples and stories; they don't change the arc.

Step	What happens	Share of time	Teacher's job
1. SHOW	Teacher demonstrates the skill once, start to finish, on the demo business.	15-20%	Narrate <i>why</i> each step matters, not just what to click. Keep it under 10 minutes.
2. TRY	Students repeat the same steps on the same demo data, together.	20-25%	Go step by step. Wait for thumbs-up before moving on. Producer watches chat for anyone stuck.
3. BUILD	Students apply it to <i>their own</i> business.	40-50%	Circulate (breakout rooms or screen-share check-ins). Unblock, don't take over.
4. SHARE	2-3 students show what they built; group debrief.	10-15%	Celebrate, name one improvement per share, connect to the next lesson.

Talk time limit: the teacher talks no more than one-third of any live session. If you notice you've been talking for 15 minutes straight, stop and give the room a task.

3. What's fixed vs. what you can make your own

Each lesson plan marks content with these labels:

Label	Meaning
★ MUST TEACH	Fixed. Every teacher covers this, in this order, every time. These are what the outcomes and assignments depend on.
◆ RECOMMENDED	Cover it if time allows. Skip only if the group is behind.
○ YOUR CHOICE	Your own examples, stories, extra tips. This is where your experience shines.

Fixed across all teachers: learning objectives, ★ points, the demo business and its data, the assignment, the rubric, session timing (± 10 minutes), the safety rules in section 7, and the student-facing promises on the website (deliverable, course credit, response times).

Yours to choose: stories, analogies, extra examples from your own clients (anonymized), which student shares, humor, pacing within a segment, which tool you demo *if* the plan says "any assistant" or "any automation tool".

If you think a ★ point is wrong or out of date, don't skip it. Teach it, then file a **Guide Change Request** (section 11) so every teacher gets the fix.

4. The demo businesses (use these, not real clients)

Every teacher demos on the same fictional businesses with the same sample data. That keeps demos consistent, keeps client data private, and lets students follow along exactly. Sample data files live in `academy/demo-data/` (to be created; see section 12).

Demo business	Used in	Snapshot
Lakeside Home Services	General classes (T01-T06, T11-T13, T17)	6-person plumbing and HVAC company. Owner: Jordan. Gets 40 inquiries a month, sends quotes by hand, chases invoices.
Summit Freight Co.	T07 Trucking	8-truck carrier, 2 office staff, spreadsheets for loads and settlements.
Ridgeline Builders	T08 Trades	3-person remodeling crew. Estimates on paper, photos on the owner's phone.
Willow & Kiln Studio	T09 Creatives	Solo ceramic artist selling pieces, taking commissions, teaching weekend classes.

Demo business	Used in	Snapshot
Northside Neighbors Alliance	T10 Nonprofits	Small community nonprofit: youth tutoring program, one fundraiser a year, 40 volunteers.
Brightpath Dental Group	T14–T16 Teams	45-person, 3-office dental group. Used for team-training examples.

You may *mention* IEBC portfolio companies (3 Lakes Logistics, Ceces Pieces, Jacks of All Trades) as real-world case studies using only what is published on the IEBC website. Never show their hubs, data, documents or numbers on screen.

5. Roles

Role	Live cohorts	Team trainings	Self-paced courses
Lead Teacher	Runs SHOW and SHARE, owns the room	Same	Records the videos, runs monthly Q&A
Producer / Co-instructor	Admits students, watches chat, manages breakout rooms, posts links, keeps time, takes notes for the teacher log	Required for groups over 12	Not needed
Reviewer	Scores assignments against the rubric, writes feedback within 3 business days	Optional	Scores submitted assignments

One person can be Lead and Producer for groups of 12 or fewer. Above 12, always have a Producer. Breakout rooms should be 4–6 students.

6. Before, during and after every session

6.1 Prep checklist (48 hours before)

- ☐ Re-read the lesson plan for this session, including "Watch for" notes.
- ☐ **Dry-run every demo** on the current version of each tool. AI tools change monthly; a button that moved breaks a live class. Note anything that changed in the Guide Change Request form.
- ☐ Record a **backup video** or screenshots of each demo, in case the tool or internet fails during class.
- ☐ Check the roster: names, business types, enrolled-as (individual / team / sponsor), and each student's "what do you want to get out of this" answer from the hub's Academy page. Note 2–3 businesses you can reference by name.
- ☐ Send the pre-class email (template in each guide) with the join link, what to bring and any free accounts students should create *before* class.

- ☐ Open, in browser tabs: slides, demo business data, every tool you'll demo, the assignment page, the feedback survey link.

6.2 Standard session timeline (90-minute live session)

Time	Segment
0:00–0:05	Welcome, agenda, one-question warm-up in chat
0:05–0:10	Win of the week: 1–2 students share progress from last assignment (skip in session 1)
0:10–0:25	SHOW
0:25–0:40	TRY
0:40–0:45	Break
0:45–1:15	BUILD (breakout rooms or quiet build time with check-ins)
1:15–1:25	SHARE
1:25–1:30	Assignment, preview of next session, feedback survey

Shorter or longer sessions keep the same proportions. Half-day workshops (T14) repeat the arc 2–3 times with a longer break.

6.3 After every session (same day)

- ☐ Post the recording, slides and assignment link to the class space within 24 hours.
- ☐ Fill in the **Teacher Log** (template in section 13): attendance, what ran long, what confused people, tech issues, students who need follow-up.
- ☐ Message any student who missed the session or got stuck, offering the recording and a 15-minute office-hours slot.
- ☐ Update the student's status in the hub if anything changed (for example, cancelled).

7. Safety and honesty rules (non-negotiable)

1. **No real personal data in AI tools on screen or in exercises.** Students use the demo data or redacted data. Teach the rule explicitly in every class's first session: *"Never paste customer names, phone numbers, Social Security numbers, account numbers, health information or passwords into an AI tool unless your company has approved that tool for that data."*
2. **Always show an AI mistake.** In every class, at least once, show AI output that is wrong or made up and how you caught it. Students must leave knowing that AI output is a draft until a human checks it.
3. **Not legal, tax or financial advice.** In T03, T04, T10 and T16, say the disclaimer out loud at the start and on the first slide. When a student asks a question that needs a lawyer or CPA, say so and move on. Don't guess.

4. **Don't overpromise results.** Don't quote "hours saved" numbers you can't back up. Teach students to measure their own before/after (every course includes this).
 5. **No hard selling.** You may mention once, at the end of the course, that the course fee is credited toward an IEBC build within 90 days and that the student can book a free call. That's it. If a student asks for help beyond the class, hand them to the IEBC team; don't pitch during class.
 6. **Accessibility.** Turn on live captions. Share slides before class. Describe what's on screen ("I'm clicking the blue Save button in the top right") for anyone who can't see it well. Offer an alternative to on-camera shares.
 7. **Recording consent.** Say at the start that the session is recorded for enrolled students only. Students can keep cameras off. Never post recordings publicly.
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8. Teaching AI specifically: what works

- **Teach the pattern, not the button.** Tools change. Teach the reusable pattern (for example, "trigger → action → check" or "role, context, task, format") and treat the specific tool as one example of the pattern. If a student uses a different tool, they should still be able to follow.
 - **Use the student's own work by the second half of every session.** Motivation jumps when the example is their inbox, their invoice, their customer.
 - **Name the fear.** Some students worry AI will replace them or that they're "not technical." Say early: *"If you can write an email and fill out a form, you can do everything in this class."* For staff in team trainings, frame AI as removing the parts of the job nobody likes.
 - **Prompting is writing.** Students who struggle with prompts usually struggle with being specific. Coach them to explain the task the way they'd explain it to a new employee.
 - **Mixed levels:** give fast finishers a "stretch" task (each lesson plan has one) and pair them with someone who's stuck. Never let the fastest student set the pace.
 - **When a demo breaks:** say so calmly, switch to the backup recording, and turn it into a lesson: *"This is real life with AI tools. Here's how I'd troubleshoot."*
 - **When you don't know:** *"Good question. I don't know yet. I'll find out and post the answer in the class space by tomorrow."* Then do it.
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9. Assignments, feedback and completion

- Every assignment has a **rubric with 3 levels:** *Not yet, Meets, Strong*. The rubric is in each guide. Reviewers score against it, not against their personal taste.
- Feedback format, every time: **one thing that works, one thing to improve, one next step.** Keep it under 150 words. Return within 3 business days.
- **Completion:** a student completes a course when every assignment reaches *Meets* or better. They can resubmit as often as needed during the course plus 30 days.
- **Certificates of completion** go out for all paid courses. The *Certification* program (T17) has its own stricter standard.

- **Calibration:** once a month, all reviewers score the same 3 anonymized assignments separately, then compare. Differences of more than one level get discussed until the team agrees, and the rubric wording gets tightened if needed.

10. Teacher onboarding: how a new teacher gets cleared for a class

A teacher is cleared **per class**, not for the whole Academy.

Step	What	Signed off by
1	Read this playbook and the class guide. Complete every assignment in the class yourself as a student would.	Self
2	Shadow one full run of the class (live or recordings) and fill in a Teacher Log as if you were teaching.	Lead teacher for that class
3	Co-teach one run: you lead at least half the sessions with the lead teacher present.	Lead teacher
4	Solo, observed: you teach a full run; an experienced teacher observes at least one session and scores it with the Observation Checklist below.	Academy lead
5	Score 5 sample assignments; your scores must match the calibration key within one level.	Academy lead

Observation Checklist (score each 1–3):

- Followed the Build-Along arc; talk time under one-third
- Covered every ★ point, in order
- Every student had something built by the end
- Showed an AI mistake and how to catch it
- Followed the safety rules (no real data, disclaimers where required)
- Handled a question or problem calmly and accurately
- Stayed within ± 10 minutes of the timeline
- Students' feedback-survey average of 4 out of 5 or higher

11. Keeping the guides current (version control)

- The guides live in this folder in the IEBC-MASTERHUB repository. The newest timestamped file is the current version. Don't edit your own private copy; propose changes instead.
- **Guide Change Request:** after any session, note in the Teacher Log what should change (a tool moved a button, a ★ point confused people, a timing is unrealistic). The Academy lead reviews requests every two weeks and publishes a new timestamped version.

- **Quarterly tool review:** every quarter, one teacher re-runs every demo in every guide and updates the "Tool notes" section of each guide.
- When the website catalog changes (price, length, outcome), the class guide changes too. The website course list (`ACADEMY_COURSES` in the website's `index.html`) is the source of truth for what's promised to students.

12. Materials still to build (shared across classes)

These are referenced by the guides and should be built once, then shared by every teacher:

- ☐ Slide template in IEBC brand (navy/gold) with title, agenda, demo, activity, recap and assignment slide layouts
- ☐ Demo data for each demo business (customers, invoices, loads, artwork, donors) as spreadsheets in `academy/demo-data/`
- ☐ Worksheets: Time Audit, Prompt Library, 30-Day Launch Checklist, Content Calendar, Agent Job Description, Opportunity Map
- ☐ Feedback survey (3 questions, below)
- ☐ Certificate of completion template
- ☐ Class space (community or shared folder) per cohort

Standard feedback survey (every session, 1 minute):

1. How useful was today's session for your business? (1-5)
2. Did you leave with something working? (Yes / Partly / No)
3. One thing we should change? (free text)

13. Templates

13.1 Lesson plan template (every guide uses this layout)

```
### Session/Module N: Title
Objective: By the end, students can ...
Time: ... minutes (live) / ... minutes of video (self-paced)
Materials: ...
★ MUST TEACH: 1. ... 2. ... 3. ...
SHOW (demo): steps ...
TRY (guided): steps ...
BUILD (own business): task ...
SHARE / CHECK: questions to ask ...
Stretch task: ...
Watch for: common mistakes and how to respond ...
Assignment: ... | Rubric: Not yet / Meets / Strong
```

13.2 Teacher Log (after every session)

Class / session: _____ Date: _____ Teacher: _____ Producer: _____
 Attendance: __ of __ Recording posted: Y/N
 What went well: _____
 What ran long or short (and by how much): _____
 Where students got confused: _____
 Tech or tool problems (what changed in the tool?): _____
 Students needing follow-up (name + why): _____
 Guide Change Request (if any): section, current text, proposed change, reason
 Survey average: __ / 5 "Left with something working": __% yes

13.3 Pre-class email

Subject: [Class name] starts [day, date, time]: what to bring

Hi [first name],

You're all set for [class name]. Here's what you need:

- Join link: [link] (opens 10 minutes early)
- Bring: a laptop (not just a phone), and [class-specific list from the guide]
- Before class, please create free accounts at: [tools from the guide]
- Have ready: [one real task / document from your business, with private details removed]

We'll build [session 1 deliverable] together, so you'll leave with it working.

See you there,
 [Teacher name], IEBC Academy

13.4 Self-paced video recording standard

- Each lesson video is **6-12 minutes**; split longer topics into parts.
- Same arc: 1-minute intro (what you'll build and why), SHOW, then a clear on-screen "Your turn" card with the TRY and BUILD steps written out, then a 30-second recap.
- Record at 1080p, zoom the browser to 125% so text is readable, use the demo data, turn on a cursor highlight, and add captions before publishing.
- Every video ends by pointing to the worksheet or assignment for that lesson.
- Re-record any video when the tool's screens change enough to confuse a student.

14. Class guide index

#	Class	Format	Guide
T01	AI for Small Business Owners in 60 Minutes	Free webinar	T01_AI_Intro_Webinar_*.md

#	Class	Format	Guide
T02	AI Admin Automation: Get Your Week Back	Self-paced	T02_AI_Admin_Automation_*.md
T03	AI Bookkeeping: Receipts to Tax Export	Self-paced	T03_AI_Bookkeeping_*.md
T04	Start It Right	Self-paced	T04_Start_It_Right_*.md
T05	Build a Website That Sells, with AI	Self-paced	T05_Website_With_AI_*.md
T06	AI Marketing and Social Content Engine	Self-paced	T06_AI_Marketing_*.md
T07	AI for Trucking and Logistics	Industry track	T07_AI_Trucking_*.md
T08	AI for Contractors and the Trades	Industry track	T08_AI_Trades_*.md
T09	AI for Creatives and Makers	Industry track	T09_AI_Creatives_*.md
T10	AI for Nonprofits	Industry track	T10_AI_Nonprofits_*.md
T11	AI Automation 4-Week Live Cohort	Live cohort	T11_Cohort_AI_Automation_*.md
T12	Build Your Business Hub in 6 Weeks	Live cohort	T12_Cohort_Business_Hub_*.md
T13	Build Your AI Workforce	Live cohort	T13_Cohort_AI_Agents_*.md
T14	AI Readiness Workshop for Teams	Team training	T14_Team_AI_Readiness_Workshop_*.md
T15	AI at Work: Department Bootcamp	Team training	T15_Team_Department_Bootcamp_*.md
T16	Responsible AI Policy and Safe-Use Training	Team training	T16_Team_AI_Policy_*.md
T17	IEBC Certified Integrated Efficiency Consultant	Certification	T17_Certification_*.md

Self-paced classes and industry tracks are taught twice: once when the teacher records the videos (use the guide's lesson plans as recording outlines), and again every month in a live Q&A and assignment review. Each self-paced guide includes a Q&A session plan.